CA Register Notes — 3 June 2026

Sources: Vision IAS · Vajiram & Ravi · PIB · Web Search
GS-I · GS-II · GS-III · GS-IV | UPSC Prelims + Mains
Items: 14 exam-relevant | 6 High · 6 Medium · 2 Low

Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

■ HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

PRS Annual Review of State Legislatures 2025

GS-II Polity → State Legislature

■ NEWS TRIGGER

PRS Legislative Research released its Annual Review of State Laws 2025, covering 27 states and UTs. Key finding: 600+ Bills passed in 2025, with nearly 30% cleared on the very day of introduction. Legislatures met for an average of only 24 days. 127 ordinances promulgated (up from 100 in 2024). 8 states/UTs had no Deputy Speaker as of May 2026.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

PRS Legislative Research is an **independent non-profit** organisation that analyses legislative functioning across India. It is NOT a government body. Its annual review is the primary source for data on how state legislatures function — sitting days, bills passed, scrutiny quality, and constitutional compliance.

Founded to improve quality of legislative debate; tracks Parliament and state assemblies. Relied upon by UPSC setters for data-based governance questions.

■ TIMELINE

2024 — 100 ordinances promulgated across states

2025 — 127 ordinances; 600+ Bills; 30% same-day passage

May 2026 — 8 states/UTs without a Deputy Speaker

Jharkhand — Deputy Speaker post vacant for 20+ years

■ KEY DATA

Metric	Data Point	Constitutional Link
Bills passed (2025)	600+	Legislative process
Same-day passage	~30% of Bills	Weak deliberation
Avg sitting days (Assembly)	24 days	Art. 174 (6-month gap max)
Lowest sitting days	Nagaland: 7 days	Art. 174
Committee referral rate	5% of Bills (6 states)	Weak scrutiny
Working hours (avg)	133 hrs/year	—
Ordinances promulgated	127 in 2025 (↑ from 100)	Art. 213 (Governor)
States without Deputy Speaker	8 states/UTs	Art. 178
Budget discussion avg	8 days only	Fiscal accountability
Budget committees	Most states lack detailed committees	Financial scrutiny

■ STATIC THEORY

• **Art. 174** — Governor summons legislature; maximum 6-month gap between two sessions. Token 1-day sessions are technically legal.

• **Art. 178** — Every assembly must elect a Speaker AND Deputy Speaker 'as soon as may be' — NO hard deadline, so prolonged vacancies are constitutionally grey.

• **Art. 200** — Governor's assent to Bills. Delays and discretionary handling create Centre-State tension.

• **Art. 213** — Governor's ordinance-making power when legislature is NOT in session. Ordinances lapse if not ratified within 6 weeks of reassembly.

• **Art. 123** — President's ordinance power (Union) — NOT the same as Art. 213 (State).

• **NCRWC** (National Commission to Review the Working of the Constitution) recommended minimum mandatory sitting days for state legislatures.

• **Deliberative democracy** concept: legislatures must debate, scrutinise, and check the executive — not just rubber-stamp Bills.

• **Executive dominance**: when law-making is driven by Cabinet and Bills are passed without committee scrutiny, separation of powers weakens.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. PRS = independent **non-profit** (NOT govt body)

2. 600+ bills in 2025; **30%** passed same day

3. Avg sitting: **24 days** (assembly), **26 days** (council)

4. Only **5%** of Bills referred to committees

5. **127** ordinances in 2025 ↑ from 100 — Art. **213**

6. Deputy Speaker vacant in **8 states/UTs** — Art. **178**

7. Jharkhand: Deputy Speaker post vacant **20+ years**

8. Budget scrutiny avg: only **8 days**

UPSC TRAPS

✗ Art. 174 = Legislature must meet every 6 months

✓ Art. 174 = gap CANNOT EXCEED 6 months (1-day token sessions are valid)

✗ Art. 178 sets a hard deadline for Deputy Speaker election

✓ 'As soon as may be' = no enforceable deadline

✗ Governor's ordinance = Art. 123

✓ Art. 123 = President (Union); Art. 213 = Governor (State)

✗ PRS is a statutory/government body

✓ PRS is an independent non-profit research organisation

MAINS ANGLE

Decline of deliberative democracy — state legislatures increasingly serve as executive approval bodies. Constitutional provisions (Art. 174, 178) allow technical compliance while gutting substantive accountability. NCRWC reforms and mandatory committee referral are the way forward.

STUDY LINK

Start Polity State Legislature

HIGH

WPI Phase-Out → Producer Price Index (PPI)

GS-III Economy → Inflation Indices

NEWS TRIGGER

Government decided to gradually phase out the Wholesale Price Index (WPI) over the next 5 years and replace it with a Producer Price Index (PPI) system. WPI base year revised from 2011-12 to 2022-23; items expanded from 697 to 957. Solar, wind, and nuclear energy added to energy basket. Released by: DPIIT, MoCI.

INTRO & ORIGIN

WPI measures average change in prices of goods at the **first point of bulk commercial sale** in the domestic market. It is the primary producer-side inflation indicator in India. PPI, its replacement, measures prices **received by producers** for goods and services in both domestic and export markets.

WPI has been India's wholesale inflation benchmark since independence. IMF and advanced economies use PPI as the global standard. India is now aligning with IMF's System of National Accounts recommendations.

TIMELINE

Pre-2017 — WPI base year: 2004-05

2017 — WPI revised — new base year 2011-12, 697 items

	2026 — WPI base year revised to 2022-23, 957 items; PPI transition announced **2031 (est.)** — Full replacement of WPI by PPI (5-year timeline)

■ KEY DATA

Index	Measures	Released by	Frequency	Key Note
CPI	Consumer prices (retail)	MoSPI	Monthly	Used by RBI for monetary policy
WPI (current)	First point of bulk sale	DPIIT, MoCI	Monthly	Base year now 2022-23, 957 items
PPI (new)	Price received by producer (domestic + exports)	DPIIT, MoCI	Quarterly	Output + Input + Service PPI

■ STATIC THEORY

• **WPI** = Wholesale Price Index. Tracks price changes at the first commercial transaction point — not consumer-facing.

• **PPI** = Producer Price Index. Measures price a producer receives — more comprehensive as it includes services and exports.

• **CPI** = Consumer Price Index. Tracks retail prices paid by consumers. Used by RBI's Monetary Policy Committee as inflation target benchmark.

• **MoSPI** releases CPI; **DPIIT/MoCI** releases WPI and will release PPI.

• **IMF recommendation**: PPI over WPI because PPI captures input cost pressures and their pass-through to output prices — critical for monetary policy analysis.

• **Three PPI components**: (1) Output PPI — prices received for goods sold, (2) Input PPI — prices paid for inputs, (3) Service PPI — price for services. All compiled quarterly.

• **Inflation transmission**: WPI leads CPI — rise in wholesale prices eventually feeds into retail. PPI will improve this signal by capturing services too.

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. WPI released by **DPIIT, Office of Economic Adviser, MoCI** (NOT RBI, NOT MoSPI)

2. New WPI base year: **2022-23** (was 2011-12); items: **957** (was 697)

3. PPI measures price **received by producer** (domestic + exports)

4. PPI compiled **quarterly**; has Output + Input + **Service** PPI

5. PPI aligns with **IMF** recommendations — global best practice

6. CPI remains separate — released by **MoSPI** for monetary policy

7. WPI phased out over **5 years** from 2026

■■ UPSC TRAPS

✗ WPI released by RBI or MoSPI

✓ WPI (and future PPI) released by DPIIT, MoCI

✗ PPI measures what consumer pays

✓ PPI = price received BY producer (not paid by consumer — that's CPI)

✗ WPI measures retail prices

✓ WPI = first point of bulk COMMERCIAL transaction (wholesale, not retail)

✗ WPI new base year is 2017-18

✓ New base year is 2022-23 (2017-18 was never the WPI base)

✗ PPI replaces CPI

✓ PPI replaces WPI only; CPI continues separately

■ **MAINS ANGLE**

India's shift from WPI to PPI reflects alignment with IMF best practices. PPI's inclusion of services and export prices provides more comprehensive inflation signal for monetary policy, input cost analysis, and pass-through assessment.

■ **STUDY LINK**

Start Economics Price Indices

HIGH

India Seafood Exports — Record High FY 2025-26

GS-III Economy → Agriculture, Blue Economy, Trade

■ **NEWS TRIGGER**

India's seafood exports hit an all-time high in FY 2025-26: 19.72 lakh MT worth Rs 73,890 crore (USD 8.46 billion). Frozen shrimp dominated at 40% volume and 66% value. USA = largest market by value; China = largest by volume. Data released by MPEDA (Marine Products Export Development Authority).

■ **INTRO & ORIGIN**

India is the world's 3rd largest fish producer and 2nd largest aquaculture producer. The fisheries sector contributes ~1.09% to national GDP, over 6% to agricultural GDP, and supports 2.8 crore livelihoods — primarily in coastal and vulnerable communities.

MPEDA (under MoCI) has promoted marine exports since 1972. PMMSY (PM Matsya Sampada Yojana, 2020) with Rs 20,050 crore investment modernised the sector. FIDF provides concessional infrastructure finance.

■ **TIMELINE**

2020 — PMMSY launched — Rs 20,050 cr investment for fisheries modernisation

FY24-25 — Seafood exports at previous record

FY25-26 — New record: 19.72 lakh MT, Rs 73,890 cr, USD 8.46 bn

■ **KEY DATA**

Product	Volume (MT)	Value (USD)	Key Note
Frozen Shrimp	7,92,647 MT	USD 5.62 bn	40% qty, 66% value; Vannamei + Black Tiger
Frozen Fish	2nd largest	USD 643.7 mn	Steady growth
Dried Seafood	3rd largest	USD 577.4 mn	78% growth (fastest riser)
Frozen Squid	1 lakh+ MT	USD 513 mn	Crossed 1 lakh MT milestone
Total Exports	19.72 lakh MT	USD 8.46 bn	HIGHEST EVER recorded

■ **STATIC THEORY**

• **MPEDA** (Marine Products Export Development Authority) — promotes seafood exports via quality certification, market intelligence, branding. Under **Ministry of Commerce & Industry**.

• **PMMSY** (PM Matsya Sampada Yojana) — 2020, Rs 20,050 crore. Covers aquaculture expansion, broodstock development, value addition, export promotion, fisher livelihoods.

• **FIDF** (Fisheries & Aquaculture Infrastructure Development Fund) — provides concessional finance for fishing harbours, cold-chain, processing units.

• **Blue Economy** — sustainable utilisation of ocean resources (fisheries, maritime trade, renewable ocean energy, tourism). Fisheries is a key pillar.

• **Vannamei Shrimp** (Litopenaeus vannamei) — Pacific white shrimp; most farmed shrimp species; dominates India's aquaculture exports.

• India's fish production ranking: **3rd globally** in fish production; **2nd globally** in aquaculture — common exam confusion (not 1st).

• **Export destination split**: USA = largest by VALUE; China = largest by VOLUME — frequently swapped in UPSC options.

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Record exports: **19.72 lakh MT**, **Rs 73,890 cr** = **USD 8.46 bn**

2. Frozen Shrimp = **40%** volume, **66%** value of all seafood exports

3. India = **3rd** fish producer, **2nd** aquaculture producer globally

4. Fisheries: **1.09% GDP**, **6%+ agri-GDP**, **2.8 crore** livelihoods

5. USA = largest by **value**; China = largest by **volume**

6. PMMSY = **Rs 20,050 crore** (2020) — MPEDA under **MoCI**

■■ UPSC TRAPS

✗ India is the 2nd largest fish producer globally

✓ India is 3rd in fish production; 2nd in aquaculture

✗ USA is India's largest seafood export market by volume

✓ USA = largest by VALUE; China = largest by VOLUME

✗ MPEDA is under Ministry of Fisheries

✓ MPEDA is under Ministry of Commerce and Industry

■ MAINS ANGLE

Blue Economy and seafood exports as pillars of India's agricultural export strategy — PMMSY, MPEDA, and FIDF as institutional enablers. Coastal livelihood and foreign exchange dimensions relevant for GS-III economy and Blue Economy questions.

■ STUDY LINK

Start Economics Blue Economy

HIGH

NITI Aayog Frontier Tech Hub (FTH)

GS-III S&T → Semiconductors, AI, Quantum Computing

■ NEWS TRIGGER

NITI Aayog's Frontier Tech Hub released reports on India's Semiconductor Vision 2035 and a Quantum Economy Roadmap. Target: USD 120-150 billion semiconductor value chain by 2035; top-3 quantum economy. India Semiconductor Mission 2.0 (ISM 2.0) announced.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Frontier Tech Hub (FTH) is a NITI Aayog initiative to steer India's strategy in next-generation technologies — semiconductors, AI, and quantum computing — ensuring India leads rather than follows in the next wave of technological disruption.

FTH works with MeitY, DST, and DRDO. Aligned with Viksit Bharat 2047 goal of technology sovereignty and reducing import dependency in strategic sectors.

■ TIMELINE

2021 — India Semiconductor Mission (ISM 1.0) announced

2023 — National Quantum Mission launched — Rs 6,003 cr, 8 years

2026 — ISM 2.0 announced; FTH Semiconductor Vision 2035 report; Quantum Economy Roadmap

2035 — Target: USD 120-150 bn semiconductor chain; top-3 quantum economy

■ KEY DATA

Domain	Target / Key Fact	Nodal Body
Semiconductors	USD 120-150 bn value chain; 10-13% global market share by 2035	MeitY / ISM
Semiconductor investment	USD 135-180 bn over 10 years	MeitY
AI	Unlock $1.7 trillion additional economic value for India over 10 years	MeitY / FTH
Quantum Computing	Top-3 quantum economy; >50% global quantum software market by 2035	DST
National Quantum Mission	Rs 6,003 cr, 8 years (approved 2023)	DST

■ STATIC THEORY

• **Semiconductor**: foundational chip technology; critical for electronics, defence, AI, and communications. India currently imports ~100% of its semiconductor needs.

• **India Semiconductor Mission (ISM)** — under MeitY. Provides incentives for chip fabrication (fabs), design, packaging. ISM 2.0 expands scope.

• **5P Strategy** for semiconductors: Pioneering · Policy & Investment · Production · People · Partnership.

• **Quantum Computing** uses quantum mechanics (superposition, entanglement) for exponentially faster computation — strategic for defence, cryptography, drug discovery.

• **National Quantum Mission (NQM)** — approved 2023, Rs 6,003 cr, 8-year mission. Goal: develop quantum computers, communication, sensing, and materials.

• **AI's economic impact** — FTH estimates AI can add $1.7 trillion to India's economy over the next decade through productivity gains across sectors.

• **Viksit Bharat 2047**: India's vision to be a developed nation by 100th independence anniversary — technology sovereignty is a core pillar.

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. FTH = **NITI Aayog** body (NOT MeitY or DST directly)

2. Semiconductor target: **USD 120-150 bn** value chain by **2035**

3. Investment: **USD 135-180 bn** over 10 years

4. AI: unlock **USD 1.7 trillion** additional economic value

5. Quantum goal: **top-3 economy** + **>50%** global software market by 2035

6. NQM = **Rs 6,003 cr**, **8 years** (approved 2023) under **DST**

7. 5P: Pioneering · Policy · Production · People · Partnership

■■ UPSC TRAPS

✗ FTH is under MeitY

✓ FTH is under NITI Aayog; ISM is under MeitY

✗ National Quantum Mission is under MeitY

✓ NQM is under Department of Science and Technology (DST)

■ MAINS ANGLE

Technology sovereignty as a pillar of Viksit Bharat 2047 — semiconductors, AI, and quantum computing are strategic sectors where India aims to lead. ISM 2.0, NQM, and FTH represent India's coordinated frontier tech strategy.

■ STUDY LINK

Start SciTech Semiconductors

HIGH

India — 2nd Largest Solar Growth Market (2025)

GS-III
Environment → Renewable Energy, Climate

■ NEWS TRIGGER

India emerged as the world's 2nd largest solar growth market in 2025, reflecting rapid expansion in solar installation capacity. Aligns with India's target of 500 GW renewable energy capacity by 2030 and its NDC commitments under the Paris Agreement.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Solar energy has become central to India's energy transition strategy. India is among the top nations in new solar capacity additions annually, driven by declining solar tariffs, large-scale solar parks, and policy support through the National Solar Mission (NSM).

National Solar Mission (NSM) launched 2010 as part of NAPCC (National Action Plan on Climate Change). International Solar Alliance (ISA) co-founded by India and France at COP21 (2015).

■ KEY DATA

Parameter	Fact
India's solar market rank (2025)	2nd largest solar GROWTH market globally
Renewable energy target	500 GW by 2030
ISA founded	COP21, 2015 — India + France; HQ: Gurugram
NSM	National Solar Mission — part of NAPCC (2010)
India's NDC target	50% energy from non-fossil sources by 2030
Current solar capacity (approx)	~90 GW+ installed (growing rapidly)

■ STATIC THEORY

• **National Solar Mission** — one of 8 missions under NAPCC. Targets 100 GW solar by 2022 (expanded). Now part of 500 GW renewable target by 2030.

• **ISA** (International Solar Alliance) — treaty-based international organisation. Co-founded by India and France at COP21. HQ: Gurugram. >120 member countries.

• **India's NDC** (Nationally Determined Contribution) — India committed to 50% energy from non-fossil sources by 2030, and net-zero by 2070.

• **PM KUSUM** scheme — Kisan Urja Suraksha evam Utthaan Mahabhiyan. Solar pumps + grid-connected solar for farmers.

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. India = **2nd largest solar growth market** globally (2025)

2. Renewable target: **500 GW by 2030**

3. ISA = India + France, **COP21 (2015)**, HQ **Gurugram**

4. NSM = part of **NAPCC** (2010)

5. NDC: **50%** energy from non-fossil by 2030; net-zero by **2070**

■■ UPSC TRAPS

✗ India is the world's largest solar market

✓ China is #1; India is 2nd largest GROWTH market (2025)

✗ ISA was founded at COP26

✓ ISA was co-founded at COP21 (2015) by India and France

✗ ISA headquarters is in New Delhi

✓ ISA HQ is in Gurugram (not Delhi)

■ MAINS ANGLE

■ STUDY LINK

India's rapid solar growth as a demonstration of its commitment to energy transition and Paris Agreement goals. ISA, NSM, and NDC as pillars. Critical for GS-III energy security, climate diplomacy, and Viksit Bharat.	Start Environment Renewable Energy

HIGH

Supreme Court 'Triple Test' for DNA Examination

GS-II Polity → Fundamental Rights → Art. 21

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Supreme Court laid down a 'Triple Test' that courts must apply before ordering DNA examination in parentage or matrimonial disputes. The test balances the Right to Privacy (Art. 21) against the right to know biological parentage.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

DNA examination in court cases involving disputed parentage raises a fundamental rights tension: the right of privacy of the individual vs the right of a child/party to know biological truth. Courts previously ordered DNA tests without a structured test.

Right to Privacy was elevated to a fundamental right under Art. 21 by the Supreme Court in the landmark K.S. Puttaswamy v. Union of India (2017) — a 9-judge constitutional bench ruling.

■ KEY DATA

Triple Test Component	What it asks
1. Necessity	Is the DNA test truly essential to resolve the dispute?
2. Proportionality	Does the benefit to justice outweigh the privacy intrusion?
3. Last Resort	Have all other forms of evidence been exhausted first?

■ STATIC THEORY

• **Art. 21** — Right to Life and Personal Liberty. Interpreted expansively to include Right to Privacy, Right to Dignity, Right to Health, etc.

• **Puttaswamy Case (2017)** — 9-judge SC bench held that Right to Privacy is a fundamental right under Art. 21. Overruled ADM Jabalpur (1976).

• **Proportionality test** — A key constitutional standard: state action must have a legitimate aim, must be rationally connected, must be least intrusive, and the benefit must outweigh the harm.

• **CrPC Section 53** — allows bodily examination of an accused by a medical practitioner. SC now requires Triple Test before DNA test can be ordered.

• **DNA evidence** = highly accurate biological identification tool but irreversible privacy violation — once done, cannot be undone.

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. SC Triple Test = **Necessity + Proportionality + Last Resort**

2. Anchored in **Art. 21** (Right to Privacy — Puttaswamy 2017)

3. Applies to DNA tests in **parentage / matrimonial** disputes

4. DNA test is NOT automatic — Triple Test must be satisfied first

5. Puttaswamy (2017) = **9-judge bench** overruled ADM Jabalpur

■■ UPSC TRAPS

✗ Right to Privacy is under Art. 19

✓ Right to Privacy flows from Art. 21 (confirmed Puttaswamy 2017)

✗ DNA test can be ordered freely by courts

✓ SC Triple Test (Necessity + Proportionality + Last Resort) must be satisfied first

✗ Puttaswamy was a 5-judge bench decision

✓ Puttaswamy 2017 was a 9-judge constitutional bench

■ MAINS ANGLE

Judicial balancing of privacy vs truth-seeking — the Triple Test represents the proportionality doctrine in action. Relevant for GS-II Fundamental Rights, GS-IV ethics (competing obligations), and judicial interpretation questions.

■ STUDY LINK

Start Polity Fundamental Rights Article 21

■ MEDIUM UPSC RELEVANCE

MEDIUM

Operation Chakravyuh — DRI Anti-Narcotics

GS-III Internal Security → Drug Trafficking

■ NEWS TRIGGER

DRI Cochin Unit conducted Operation Chakravyuh across Kerala (Kochi, Malappuram, Thiruvananthapuram), seizing 24+ kg of narcotics (methaqualone, methamphetamine, hashish oil). 5 arrested under NDPS Act, 1985. Aligns with Nasha Mukt Bharat.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

DRI (Directorate of Revenue Intelligence) is India's apex anti-smuggling and anti-narcotics intelligence agency. It operates under CBIC, Ministry of Finance — NOT Ministry of Home Affairs (NCB is under MHA, which is the common confusion).

■ KEY DATA

Agency	Ministry	Role
DRI (Directorate of Revenue Intelligence)	Finance (CBIC)	Anti-smuggling, anti-narcotics, customs evasion
NCB (Narcotics Control Bureau)	Home Affairs (MHA)	Narcotics enforcement, demand reduction
NDPS Act	1985	Primary law governing narcotic drugs and psychotropic substances

■ STATIC THEORY

• **NDPS Act, 1985** — Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances Act. Governs production, manufacture, possession, sale, and trafficking of narcotics.

• **DRI** — under CBIC (Central Board of Indirect Taxes and Customs), Ministry of Finance. Apex anti-smuggling agency.

• **NCB** — Narcotics Control Bureau, under MHA. Focuses on enforcement of NDPS Act, international coordination (INTERPOL, UNODC).

• **Nasha Mukt Bharat Abhiyan** — national anti-drug campaign for a drug-free India.

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. DRI = CBIC, **Ministry of Finance** (NOT MHA)

2. NCB = **Ministry of Home Affairs** (NOT Finance)

3. NDPS Act = **1985**

4. Seized: **24+ kg** narcotics in Kerala; **5 arrested**

5. Other ops: Crystal Fortress (NCB), Ragepill (NCB — first Captagon in India), Garuda (CBI+INTERPOL)

■■ UPSC TRAPS

✗ DRI is under Ministry of Home Affairs

✓ DRI is under CBIC, Ministry of Finance. NCB is under MHA.

✗ NDPS Act was passed in 1988

✓ NDPS Act was enacted in 1985

■ MAINS ANGLE

■ STUDY LINK

Synthetic drug trafficking and transnational networks — need for inter-agency coordination (DRI + NCB + State Police + INTERPOL).	Start InternalSecurity NarcoticsControl

---

MEDIUM

Operation Mule Hunt 1.0 — Gujarat Cyber Crime

GS-III Internal Security → Cybercrime, Digital Fraud

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Gujarat Police's Cyber Centre of Excellence (CCoE) conducted Operation Mule Hunt 1.0. 565 FIRs, 638 arrested, 913 mule accounts actioned, Rs 2,289 crore cyber fraud exposed, 4,052 cases identified across India. Uses I4C, NCRP, 1930 helpline, MuleHunter.ai.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

A 'mule account' is a bank account used as an intermediary to channel and launder proceeds of cybercrime. The account holder may be unaware, inducing individuals with small payments. Multiple layers of transactions hide the actual criminal.

■ KEY DATA

Platform / Initiative	Under	Purpose
I4C (Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre)	MHA	Nodal agency for cybercrime prevention
NCRP (National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal)	MHA / I4C	Citizens report cybercrime online
1930 Cyber Helpline	MHA	Immediate financial fraud reporting
IDPIC + AI risk-scoring	RBI guidelines	Classify transactions Low/Medium/High risk
MuleHunter.ai	Banks / RBI ecosystem	Inter-bank mule account info-sharing registry

■ STATIC THEORY

• **Money laundering** — process of making illegally obtained money appear legitimate through layering (multiple transactions), placement, and integration.

• **PMLA 2002** (Prevention of Money Laundering Act) — primary law against money laundering. ED (Enforcement Directorate) is the implementing agency.

• **Digital India** — expanding digital payments increases both opportunity and risk for cyber fraud via mule accounts.

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. CCoE = Gujarat Police | **565 FIRs** | **638 arrested** | **Rs 2,289 cr** fraud

2. I4C and 1930 helpline → under **MHA**

3. IDPIC risk-scoring → under **RBI** guidelines (not MHA)

4. MuleHunter.ai = bank inter-sharing registry

5. 913 mule accounts actioned; 4,052 cases across India

■■ UPSC TRAPS

✗ I4C is under RBI

✓ I4C (Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre) is under MHA

✗ IDPIC operates under MHA

✓ IDPIC's AI risk-scoring operates under RBI guidelines

■ MAINS ANGLE

■ STUDY LINK

Cybercrime and digital payment security — institutional architecture (I4C, NCRP, IDPIC) and the challenge of mule account proliferation in India's digital economy.	Start InternalSecurity Cybercrime

MEDIUM

Delayed SW Monsoon 2026 — El Niño Impact

GS-I Geography → Monsoon System, Climate

■ **NEWS TRIGGER**

Southwest Monsoon 2026 delayed due to El Niño conditions in the Pacific. Normal onset over Kerala is 1 June (±7 days). Delayed onset risks kharif crop planting, reservoir levels, hydel power, and food price inflation.

■ **KEY DATA**

Concept	Effect on India
El Niño (warm Pacific)	Weakens/delays SW Monsoon → below-normal rainfall
La Niña (cool Pacific)	Strengthens SW Monsoon → above-normal rainfall
Indian Ocean Dipole (IOD)+	Positive IOD partially offsets El Niño's negative impact
Normal onset (Kerala)	1 June (±7 days); progresses to cover whole India by ~15 July

■ **STATIC THEORY**

• **SW Monsoon** = June to September. Originates from Arabian Sea and Bay of Bengal branches. Meets at Central India.

• **El Niño** = warming of central/eastern equatorial Pacific. Disrupts Walker Circulation, weakens the thermal gradient that drives the Indian monsoon.

• **ENSO** (El Niño Southern Oscillation) — climate pattern alternating between El Niño, La Niña, and neutral phases.

• **Kharif crops** — sown June-July with SW monsoon onset (rice, cotton, maize, pulses). Delayed monsoon = delayed sowing = reduced yield.

■ **MUST-KNOW FACTS**

1. SW Monsoon normal onset Kerala = **1 June** (±7 days)

2. El Niño = warm Pacific → weaker/delayed monsoon

3. La Niña = cool Pacific → stronger/early monsoon

4. Impact chain: delayed monsoon → kharif delay → food inflation → **CPI pressure**

■■ **UPSC TRAPS**

✗ El Niño always causes drought in India

✓ El Niño weakens/delays monsoon but doesn't always cause full drought — IOD+ can offset

■ **MAINS ANGLE**

Climate variability (El Niño) and its cascading effects on India's food security, agricultural output, and macroeconomic stability.

■ **STUDY LINK**

Start Geography MonsoonSystem

MEDIUM

India-Azerbaijan: Tagore-Nizami Library

GS-II International Relations → Bilateral, Soft Power

■ **NEWS TRIGGER**

India and Azerbaijan established the Tagore-Nizami Library — a cultural diplomacy initiative named after Rabindranath Tagore (India) and Nizami Ganjavi (Azerbaijan). Reflects India's soft power strategy and people-to-people connect.

■ **KEY DATA**

Element	Detail
Tagore	Rabindranath Tagore — India's Nobel laureate poet, cultural icon
Nizami Ganjavi	Azerbaijan's national poet (12th century), Caucasus literary figure
Strategic link	Azerbaijan is part of INSTC (International North-South Transport Corridor)
Energy link	Azerbaijan is an oil/gas transit state — India's energy diversification
Soft power tools	ICCR, yoga diplomacy, libraries, Bollywood, Buddha diplomacy

■ **STATIC THEORY**

• **INSTC** (International North-South Transport Corridor) — 7,200 km multi-modal route connecting India to Russia via Iran and Azerbaijan. Reduces shipping time from 30-40 days to ~15 days vs Suez route.

• **Soft power** — Joseph Nye's concept: the ability to shape preferences of others through attraction (culture, values, policies) rather than coercion (hard power).

• **ICCR** (Indian Council for Cultural Relations) — India's apex body for cultural diplomacy. Promotes Indian arts, language, culture globally.

■ **MUST-KNOW FACTS**

1. Library named after **Tagore** (India) + **Nizami Ganjavi** (Azerbaijan)

2. Azerbaijan connects to **INSTC** (North-South Transport Corridor)

3. Soft power = culture, values, people-to-people connect (Joseph Nye concept)

4. ICCR = apex body for India's cultural diplomacy

■■ **UPSC TRAPS**

✗ INSTC connects India to Europe via Suez

✓ INSTC connects India to Russia/Europe via Iran and Azerbaijan — bypasses Suez

■ **MAINS ANGLE**

Cultural diplomacy as an instrument of India's foreign policy — libraries, ICCR, yoga, Bollywood as soft power tools. Azerbaijan's strategic importance via INSTC.

■ **STUDY LINK**

Start IR SoftPower

MEDIUM

Mission Senehjori — Assam Muga Silk

GS-III + GS-I
Economy → GI Tags, Textile | Art & Culture

■ **NEWS TRIGGER**

Assam government launched Mission Senehjori to strengthen the Muga Silk value chain and position it as a global luxury brand. 'Senehjori' means golden thread in Assamese. Muga Silk is unique to Assam and holds a Geographical Indication (GI) tag.

■ **KEY DATA**

Silk Type	State	Colour	GI Tag
Muga Silk	Assam ONLY	Golden/amber	Yes
Mysore Silk	Karnataka	Various	Yes
Kanchipuram Silk	Tamil Nadu	Various (zari)	Yes
Banarasi Silk	Uttar Pradesh	Various	Yes
Eri Silk	Assam (also)	White/brick	Yes

■ STATIC THEORY

• **Muga Silk** — produced by Antheraea assamensis silkworm; semi-wild; found ONLY in Assam's Brahmaputra valley. Natural golden colour; extremely durable; improves with washing.

• **GI Tag** (Geographical Indication) — protects products with specific geographical origin and quality/reputation linked to that origin. Governed by GI of Goods Act, 1999.

• **ODOP** (One District One Product) — promotes unique local products from each district. Links to artisan livelihoods, rural employment.

• **Silk Board of India** — under Ministry of Textiles. Promotes all types of silk production in India.

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Muga Silk = **Assam ONLY** (NOT Karnataka — that's Mysore Silk)

2. Natural **golden colour** — improves with age and washing

3. Has **GI tag**; 'Senehjori' = golden thread in Assamese

4. GI Act = **1999** | GI tag ≠ trademark (geographical, not commercial)

■■ UPSC TRAPS

✗ Muga Silk is produced in Karnataka

✓ Muga Silk is produced ONLY in Assam; Karnataka has Mysore Silk

■ MAINS ANGLE

GI tags and artisan livelihoods — how protecting traditional crafts (Muga, Kanchipuram, Banarasi) supports rural employment and cultural heritage.

■ STUDY LINK

Start ArtCulture GITags

MEDIUM PM SVANidhi — 6th Anniversary

GS-II Governance → Urban Welfare Schemes

■ NEWS TRIGGER

PM SVANidhi completes 6 years (launched June 2020). Scheme provides working capital micro-credit to street vendors. Progressive loans: Rs 10,000 → Rs 20,000 → Rs 50,000. Digital transaction cashback incentive encourages UPI adoption. Under MoHUA.

■ KEY DATA

Parameter	Detail
Full name	PM Street Vendor's AtmaNirbhar Nidhi
Launch year	June 2020
Ministry	MoHUA (Housing and Urban Affairs)
Loan tiers	Rs 10,000 → Rs 20,000 → Rs 50,000 (progressive)
Digital incentive	Cashback for UPI/digital transactions

Parameter	Detail
Credit guarantee	CGTMSE (Credit Guarantee Fund Trust for MSEs)
Target beneficiaries	Street vendors (urban informal economy)

■ **STATIC THEORY**

• **PM SVANidhi** targets the urban informal sector — street vendors who lack collateral for formal bank loans.

• **MUDRA vs SVANidhi**: MUDRA (Micro Units Development Refinance Agency) covers manufacturing and service micro-enterprises broadly. SVANidhi is ONLY for street vendors.

• **MoHUA** (Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs) — also oversees Smart Cities Mission, PMAY-Urban, AMRUT, SVAMITVA.

• **AtmaNirbhar Bharat** — self-reliant India initiative; SVANidhi is part of this broader ecosystem of micro-credit schemes.

■ **MUST-KNOW FACTS**

1. PM SVANidhi = street vendor micro-credit | launched **June 2020** | **MoHUA**

2. Loan tiers: **Rs 10K** → **Rs 20K** → **Rs 50K** (progressive)

3. Digital incentive = cashback for **UPI** transactions

4. SVANidhi ≠ MUDRA (MUDRA = broader MSEs; SVANidhi = street vendors ONLY)

■■ **UPSC TRAPS**

✗ PM SVANidhi is under Ministry of MSME

✓ PM SVANidhi is under MoHUA (Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs)

✗ MUDRA and SVANidhi serve the same beneficiaries

✓ SVANidhi is specifically for street vendors; MUDRA covers broader micro-enterprises

■ **MAINS ANGLE**

Urban informal economy and financial inclusion — micro-credit, digital payments, and social protection for street vendors as pillars of inclusive urbanisation.

■ **STUDY LINK**

Start Governance UrbanWelfareSchemes

End of Register Notes — UPSC Agent / Copilot CLI